

our very daily moods tied to the discount rates. Is it possible not to be financially obsessed? I find time for little else.

This brings me to the first problem I encountered: how would I raise enough cash to invest in the great opportunities that would soon come my way. My plan to sell some extra furniture, old clothes, and other household effects met with strong resistance in my own family. They argued that if these things were investments already, what was the point of sacrificing them to some wild idea of running off and winning on Wall Street?

Fortunately, I was able to sell my own car, an old Renault, and also a twice-used sailing dinghy. The proceeds from these two sources, plus the first third of an advance from my publisher, added up to \$16,500. That is the stake with which I set out into the world of finance.